I asked a member of the British military establishment whether the UK was Israel's friend or its enemy. He thought for a very long time and then said he could not answer the question. It was both.

Other elements of western society are similarly demonising and delegitimising Israel as the pariah of the world, while ignoring or even appeasing those forces that threaten themselves. In both Britain and America, Protestant progressive churches are virulently hostile to Israel. This animus is now making inroads even into United States evangelical churches, hitherto the bedrock of Christian Zionism.

This Church hostility rests upon a theological base, embodying a revival of the ancient heresy of supersessionism. This was the doctrine that all God's promises to the Jews, including the land of Israel, were forfeit and devolved instead upon the Christians because the Jews denied the divinity of Jesus. This belief, which fuelled centuries of Christian persecution of the Jews, has now been fused with Palestinianism to persuade Christians that Palestinain Arabs rather than the Jews are the legitimate inheritors of the land of Israel.

The result has been a vicious Church campaign of demonization against Israel. In December 2013 a church in central London, St James's in Piccadilly, erected an enormous wall which it claimed represented the Israeli "wall around Bethlehem." Of course, there is no wall around Bethlehem; part of the Israeli security barrier forms a wall merely alongside part of Bethlehem, because of the significant threat otherwise of terrorists passing from there into Jerusalem. The role of the barrier in stopping murderous Palestinian attacks on Israelis was barely mentioned by the church, which instead staged a week-long hate-fest about alleged Israeli brutality against the "captive" Palestinians.

In June 2014, the Presbyterian Church (USA) biennial general assembly voted by 310–303 to divest from three American companies that do business with Israeli security services in the West Bank. In other words, the Church voted to help jeopardise the security of America. And it did so in the wake of a document called *Zionism Unsettled*, a "study guide" published by the Church's Israel-Palestine mission. This attacked "the theological and ethical exceptionalism of Jewish and Christian Zionism, which have been sheltered from open debate despite the intolerable human rights abuses rooted in their core beliefs." Zionism, it suggested, had destroyed both indigenous Palestinian lives and Jewish communities across the globe in a supremacist misinterpretation of God's word on a par with "Christian exceptionalist beliefs [that] contributed to the Nazi Holocaust, the genocide of Native Americans, and countless other instances of tragic brutality."[1]

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